

Executive Summary: ELA at OAO

ELA at OAO will be designed as a guided, on-demand learning experience for students in grades 3–5. The goal is to preserve the best parts of live instruction—teacher modeling, guided practice, interaction, skill progression, and meaningful reading discussion—while adapting them for students who are working independently and at their own pace in Canvas.

Rather than functioning as a list of separate assignments, each ELA lesson will feel like a structured learning pathway. Students will move through short instructional videos, guided reading tasks, language practice, writing activities, self-checks, and final submission steps. Teacher videos will serve as the connective thread throughout the lesson, helping students understand what they are doing, why it matters, and how each part connects to the larger learning goal.

Core Instructional Structure

OAO ELA will use a consistent weekly rhythm across grades 3–5. Most weeks will include reading, grammar, word study, vocabulary, writing, and comprehension practice. These parts will not be treated as disconnected subjects. Instead, they will work together around the novel, text, or writing focus of the week.

A typical on-demand ELA lesson may include:

1. Welcome and lesson roadmap
2. Language warm-up or Daily Oral Language
3. Word study, spelling, morphology, or vocabulary
4. Reading focus connected to the class novel or text
5. Guided practice with teacher modeling
6. Writing connection
7. Self-check or feedback moment
8. Final assignment or turn-in task

This structure gives students predictability while still allowing the content and rigor to change by grade level.

Weekly Skill Progression

One major decision was to preserve the clear action-word progression from the live homework structure. Across a week, students should not simply repeat the same kind of task each day. Instead, the objective verbs should show a learning arc.

A typical weekly pattern may be:

- Day 1: define, describe, recognize, or explain
- Day 2: identify, sort, classify, or locate
- Day 3: use, write, apply, or demonstrate
- Day 4: explain, justify, revise, evaluate, or extend

For example, a grammar skill might move from defining interjections, to identifying interjections, to writing sentences with interjections, to explaining how interjections improve writing. A spelling or morphology skill might move from learning the rule, to sorting examples, to applying the rule, to solving a challenge or explaining the pattern.

This progression will help students move from basic understanding to independent application.

Reading Instruction: “What Good Readers Do”

OAo ELA will include a recurring reading-habit strand called “What Good Readers Do.” This will help students learn how to think while they read, not just answer questions after reading.

This section may focus on habits such as:

- previewing a text
- making predictions
- using context clues
- noticing character actions and motivations
- tracking important events
- making inferences
- identifying point of view or perspective
- summarizing key ideas
- finding theme
- using text evidence

In Canvas, this should appear as a short, focused reading frame before or during the reading assignment. For example, a lesson might tell students that good readers notice when a character makes an important choice, then ask them to watch for that kind of moment as they read.

This structure helps students approach the text with purpose.

RWM: Read like a Reader, Read like a Writer, Mimic

OAo ELA will also use RWM as a recurring sentence-study routine.

RWM stands for:

- Read like a Reader
- Read like a Writer
- Mimic

In “Read like a Reader,” students think about what a sentence means and why it matters in the story. In “Read like a Writer,” students notice how the author built the sentence, including grammar, word choice, structure, and style. In “Mimic,” students imitate the sentence pattern or use it as a model for their own writing.

This routine allows grammar to be taught through real literature rather than only through isolated workbook-style practice. It connects reading, grammar, and writing in a natural way.

RWM can be used once or twice per week, depending on the grade and the lesson focus. In 3rd grade, it should use simpler sentences and more direct modeling. In 4th and 5th grade, it can become more analytical and tied to sentence variety, author's craft, and writing style.

Word Study Across Grades 3–5

Word study will include spelling, morphology, vocabulary, and phonics review where appropriate. The structure should remain consistent across grades, but the content should grow in complexity.

In 3rd grade, students will build foundational word knowledge. They will study root words, prefixes, suffixes, base words, syllables, spelling patterns, and basic word families.

In 4th grade, students will expand into Greek and Latin roots, affixes, word origins, morphology-based spelling, and academic vocabulary.

In 5th grade, students will apply morphology more independently. They will analyze complex words, use roots and affixes to determine meaning, understand shades of meaning, and apply academic vocabulary in reading and writing.

The goal is for students to see word study as a tool for reading comprehension and writing precision, not as a separate memorization task.

Vocabulary

Vocabulary will remain a regular part of ELA. Students may study vocabulary through cards, choice boards, context work, writing tasks, and word analysis.

Vocabulary should connect to the literature whenever possible. Students should define words, explain meanings in their own words, use vocabulary in context, and connect words to roots, affixes, or related words.

A vocabulary choice board can continue to be used as an independent practice tool. This is especially useful for on-demand learning because it gives students structure while allowing for some choice.

Reading Fluency

Reading fluency will be included once per week in 3rd and 4th grade. This should usually be a short paragraph excerpt from the novel or assigned text.

The fluency routine should be simple and repeated:

1. Listen to the teacher model the passage.

2. Read the passage once for accuracy.
3. Read it again for smoothness.
4. Read it a third time with expression.
5. Record and submit the final reading.

Fluency should focus on accuracy, automaticity, smoothness, and expression. When helpful, students may also answer a short comprehension or reflection question after reading.

For 5th grade, fluency does not need to be a weekly requirement unless needed. It may appear through poetry, speeches, dramatic readings, oral presentations, or targeted support.

Writing Instruction and Quarterly Writing Projects

OAO ELA will include both regular short writing practice and larger writing projects. Most weeks will include small writing connections tied to reading, grammar, vocabulary, or sentence imitation.

In addition, each quarter should include one major writing project. These projects will follow the writing process:

- brainstorm
- plan
- draft
- revise
- edit
- publish

Some weeks leading up to a major project may reduce or temporarily drop spelling, grammar, or regular reading objectives in order to make room for project setup. For example, a week might begin with normal reading and skill work, then shift on Wednesday and Thursday into brainstorming and drafting. The following week may focus on drafting, revising, editing, and publishing.

These writing weeks should not feel like interruptions. They are the point of the skill-building work. Students use the reading, grammar, vocabulary, sentence study, and morphology skills they have practiced in order to produce a polished piece of writing.

Possible quarterly writing projects may include:

- Quarter 1: personal or fictional narrative
- Quarter 2: informational or expository writing
- Quarter 3: opinion or argument writing
- Quarter 4: literary response, comparison, or research-based writing

The writing process should be heavily guided through Canvas videos, models, checklists, and checkpoints.

Poetry and Oral Language

Poetry may continue to appear as a weekly or occasional routine. Students can read poems for meaning, notice rhyme and structure, connect poems to the novel, and sometimes record themselves reading or reciting with expression.

Daily Oral Language or language warm-ups can also remain part of the weekly rhythm. These may include sentence correction, grammar review, punctuation practice, sentence combining, or noticing patterns in model sentences.

These routines should be short and purposeful so they support the larger ELA goals without crowding the lesson.

Assessment and Feedback

Because the courses are on-demand, feedback moments need to be intentionally built into the lessons.

These may include:

- short self-checks
- answer explanations
- feedback videos
- model responses
- revision checklists
- confidence ratings
- final turn-in boxes
- occasional quizzes or comprehension checks

Students should not feel like they are working through a static worksheet. They should feel guided by the teacher through each step.

Overall Design Decision

The overall decision is to build OAO ELA around a consistent but flexible structure.

Most weeks will be skill-building weeks. Students will read, think, practice grammar and word study, build vocabulary, and write in shorter forms.

Some weeks will become writing workshop weeks. Students will use the writing process to create a larger quarterly project.

Across all weeks, the course will use recurring instructional tools:

- Canvas-guided lesson pathways
- teacher instructional videos
- “What Good Readers Do” reading habits

- RWM sentence study
- weekly fluency for grades 3–4
- vocabulary choice work
- morphology and spelling progression
- guided comprehension questions
- writing-process projects
- self-checks and feedback videos

ELA at OAO should feel structured, classical, literary, and teacher-guided. Students should know what to expect each week, but the work should become deeper and more independent as they move from 3rd grade to 5th grade.